

SENATE JOINT RESOLUTION 1242

By Crowe

A RESOLUTION to honor the memory of R.L. McKinney of East Tennessee.

WHEREAS, the members of this General Assembly were greatly saddened to learn of the passing of R.L. McKinney of East Tennessee; and

WHEREAS, Mr. McKinney was a highly respected member of his community and a consummate professional who worked assiduously to improve the quality of life for his fellow citizens in numerous capacities; and

WHEREAS, born on November 1, 1953, Mr. McKinney was a skilled craftsman and devoted fifty-four years of dedicated service as an HVAC-R technician with Johnson City Schools; and

WHEREAS, R.L. McKinney served his country with honor as a member of the 776th Army National Guard, earning the respect and admiration of his fellow servicemen and community alike; and

WHEREAS, a leader in his community, Mr. McKinney was a fifty-year member and past Master of Watauga Masonic Lodge #662; he was wholly devoted to his faith and attended Doe River Baptist Church, where he served in several capacities; and

WHEREAS, R.L. McKinney was a blessing to all who were fortunate to know him, and he will be remembered for his quick wit, passion for travel, insatiable curiosity, and a boundless kindness that left a lasting mark on everyone who crossed his path; and

WHEREAS, Mr. McKinney was deeply devoted to his family and always endeavored to remain true to family values of the highest order; and

WHEREAS, left to cherish his memory are his beloved wife of forty-nine years, Juanita Culbert McKinney; his sons, Matthew N. McKinney and Andrew P. McKinney; his grandson, C.J.

McKinney; his special nephew, Tim (Christy) McKinney; his brother, Darrell Tolley; his sister, Shannon (Carlos) Posada; his cousin, Ronnie (Phyllis) Campbell; a host of nieces and nephews; his cherished bonus family, Sam (Allie) Sanders, Laura Garland, Dave Baker, Eddie (Diana) Buchanan, and Mike Peters; his special friends, Dr. Bill Neely and Melissa Leake; and his brothers of Watauga Lodge #622; and

WHEREAS, R.L. McKinney was preceded in death by his parents, Ralph and Myrtle McKinney; Odell Whitehead and Helen Tolley; his sister, Tina Callahan; his mother-in-law, Cookie Culbert; and his cousin, Rod Whitehead; and

WHEREAS, warm-hearted and endlessly curious, Mr. McKinney was a unique soul who had the ability to turn ordinary encounters into stories worth retelling; he found profound joy in the simple beauty of the mountains and his faithful canine companions, Tagan, Margaret, and Jesse; and

WHEREAS, R.L. McKinney leaves behind an indelible legacy of integrity and probity in public life, compassion and loyalty in private life, and diligence and dedication in all his chosen endeavors; and

WHEREAS, it is fitting that we should pause to remember the bountiful life of this exceptional public servant and human being; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES CONCURRING, that we honor the memory of R.L. McKinney, reflecting fondly upon his impeccable character and his stalwart commitment to living the examined life with courage and conviction.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that we express our sympathy and offer our condolences to the family of Mr. McKinney.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.